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PHOTOS BY TAYLOR COESTER FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

No cash, no problem

Time banking builds community, offers way to trade volunteer services for credit

By Yogev Toby

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Betsy Leondar-Wright is rolling in it. She can afford to get help around the house, take photography lessons, and buy custom-made jewelry. All without spending a dime.

Instead, she boasts an account stacked not with dollars, but “time credits” issued by her, well, “time bank.”

The concept of time banking has been around since the 1960s and garnered a large following in the early 2000s. Now, some people worried about inflation, an unstable job market, and constantly shifting tariffs are showing renewed interest in trying out alternative methods to spending, including time banking.

The systems, usually run by community nonprofits, allow people to trade volunteer services in return for virtual credit for each hour of work. They can

TIME BANKS, Page A5



Betsy Leondar-Wright (top, left) delivered food to Jan Innes at her apartment in Cambridge. They are members of a Cambridge time bank called Time Trade Circle. Innes racks up credits through her mending clothes and fixing jewelry.

Wager limit still leaves gamblers exposed, advocates say

Baseball scandal prompts rule tightening; some demand ban on pitch-by-pitch bets

By Joey Flechas

GLOBE STAFF

The latest sports betting scandal to rock Major League Baseball led to an immediate reform: a new \$200 ceiling on so-called prop bets on individual pitches, a limit that aims to protect the integrity of the sport by making it far less lucrative to rig specific plays.

The new caps may achieve that goal — while also protecting sportsbooks from being victimized by crooked gamblers working in cahoots with athletes. But public health advocates say the change sidesteps a thornier problem: Such microbets allow gamblers to wager fast and often, fueling addiction and still allowing bettors to lose huge

amounts of money over the course of a single game, if in smaller increments.

Apart from shaking fans’ confidence in the game, the controversy put prop bets — which might have been unknown to many casual fans — under a microscope. Advocates want to see them banned.

Federal authorities indicted Cleveland Guardians pitchers Emmanuel Clase and Luis Ortiz in November on charges they conspired with bettors to throw certain pitch-

es outside the strike zone, ensuring large payouts to gamblers who had tens of thousands of dollars riding on those outcomes. Both pitchers have pleaded not guilty. Days later, MLB and the country’s largest sportsbooks agreed to the new \$200 cap on wagers on individual pitches.

MLB said the cap, along with a ban on including such wagers in parlays — which are essentially a series of linked prop bets — will pro-

BETTING, Page A5

Odds slim for health tax credit extension

As millions face boost in premiums, Congress stalls

By Jim Puzzanghera

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — It’s the season of hope, but there’s little of that on Capitol Hill for the enhanced tax credits for Obamacare health insurance that expire New Year’s Day.

With roughly 22 million Americans facing major increases in their premiums, Republicans and Democrats are no closer to a deal to extend them that could pass both chambers of Congress than they were nearly a month ago at the end of the record-long government shutdown that was fought over this very issue.

There’s broad agreement that the expiration of the credits is a major problem that will only add to the nation’s affordability crisis. And while there is a flicker of optimism around a new bipartisan effort by rank-and-file lawmakers, the outlook is still bleak as congressional leaders remain sharply at odds. Adding to the problems, President Trump has not been actively engaged ahead of a crucial vote coming Thursday in the Senate.

ACA, Page A7

Justices poised to widen power of presidency

Target independence of key federal agencies

By Justin Jouvenal

WASHINGTON POST

The Supreme Court on Monday appeared poised to allow President Trump to fire a leader of the Federal Trade Commission, a ruling that could limit or overturn a 90-year-old precedent that curbs executive power to dismiss the heads of agencies Congress set up to be independent.

A ruling in favor of Trump’s position has been widely expected by legal experts because the justices have been chipping away for years at the precedent, known as Humphrey’s Executor. Many of the Supreme Court’s conservative justices have expressed support for the idea known as unitary executive theory, which holds that the Constitution gives the president broad authority to fire officials that Congress cannot limit.

During arguments on Monday, Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr. referred to Humphrey’s Executor as a “dried husk.” The contemporary FTC bore little resemblance to the one that existed at the

SUPREME COURT, Page A4

Do a numb brrrr on

Tuesday: Cold, breezy.
High 29-34, low 26-31.

Wednesday: Warming up.
High 43-48, low 33-38.

High tide: 2:11, 2:22.

Sunrise: 7:02. Sunset: 4:11.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

In the continuing murder trial of Brian Walshe, the cause of death of his wife remains a confounding factor. **B1.**

Hamas has restrengthened its corps and its hold on some neighborhoods, complicating a path toward peace in Gaza. **A7.**

Former anchor Kate Merrill’s racial bias lawsuit rests on “demeaning and unfounded” stereotypes and should be dismissed, defendants argue. **D1.**

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Torment and Trial | Chapter Three

‘The red flags were there’: Inside a problematic police interrogation

By Yvonne Abraham | Globe columnist

Interrogation ■ Wearing too-small paper hospital scrubs, Latarsha Sanders waited alone in an interrogation room at the Brockton police station, her hands clasped across her exposed belly.

She fell asleep, her head tilted back against the white cinderblock wall, nodded awake, talked to herself.

It had been less than three hours since police discovered the bodies of her sons Marlon, 8, and La’son, 5, in the family’s third-floor apartment.

Police had already interviewed her at Good Samaritan hospital, where she’d been taken after collapsing outside her Brockton home. In the ER, she moaned and cried, and her answers were disjointed and inconsistent. She accused her eldest son, Kadeem, and his father of killing the boys, and she said she was being followed. She told police she was upset because she saw blood on the boys and they wouldn’t wake up.

Sanders was in no condition to understand the stakes on that February afternoon in 2018. She had been injected with 2 milligrams of the anti-anxiety drug lorazepam at the hospital, and may have taken sleeping medication, too.

SANDERS, Page A6

Latarsha Sanders was convicted of first-degree murder for killing her children Marlon, 8, and La’son, 5, in 2018, even though she was experiencing severe symptoms of mental illness at the time. This series explores what led up to the horrific day when Sanders killed her sons, and how the justice system treated Sanders and her family afterwards.



PHOTOS FROM SHALEA SANDERS; NOTEBOOK SCANS YVONNE ABRAHAM; PHOTO ILLUSTRATION BY RYAN HUDDLE/GLOBE STAFF